

THE GOBBO WEEKLY

ALL THE NEWS THAT FITS INSIDE A COAT POCKET

NAVIGATION DESK EXCLUSIVE

ENTIRE TOWN ARRIVES SIDWAYS AND COUNTS IT

A shy arrow, a closed shortcut, and one excellent sandwich lead residents somewhere usefully unexpected.

BY CRUMBLY MOSS, TEMPORARY NORTH CORRESPONDENT

At 08:13 yesterday, the arrow outside Town Hall quietly rotated seventeen degrees and asked not to be made responsible for everybody's morning.

Commuters followed a chalk squiggle past the bakery,

through a patch of very persuasive ferns, and into the square from the wrong side. The mayor called this an arrival with character.

No appointments were lost. Three buns were gained. The shortcut has requested annual leave.



FIELD IMAGE 02A: Local creature declines the straight line and discovers a suspiciously good shrub.

INSIDE TODAY

- 02 Long read: Maps are not moral documents
- 03 Loitering sport, classifieds, shy arrows
- 04 Work: plans meet actual reality
- 07 Games, omens, and accidental north

CIVIC

PEBBLE NAMED INTERIM MAYOR

The pebble has promised shade, slower meetings, and no speeches longer than a pocket.

DOMESTIC

CHAIR RETIRES FROM CORNER

After nine quiet years holding coats, the chair will pursue a second career near the window.

CULTURE

KETTLE REMEMBERS ONE SONG

The tune has two notes, both steam. Reviews call it brief, sincere, and difficult to hum.

LATE BULLETIN

SCIENCE: Compass points toward soup. Researchers repeat lunch.

TRAVEL: Bus takes scenic route around one very confident duck.

FINANCE: Breadcrumb futures scattered. Pocket lint holds steady.

THE LONG READ

ROUTES / ADVICE / PRACTICAL
WANDERING

OPINION, BUT TAKING THE LONG WAY

THE MAP WAS NEVER A MORAL DOCUMENT

A field report on wrong turns, changed plans, and the strange pressure to make every path look inevitable.

WORDS BY DITCH FERN / ROUTE CHECKED BY A PATIENT BEETLE

A map is a useful rumour about the ground. It can show a bridge, a footpath, and the likely location of soup. It cannot tell you whether the route is still kind today.

We keep turning directions into verdicts. Forward becomes good. Backward becomes shameful. Sideways is treated as suspicious, despite being where nearly all the interesting doors live.

The straight line has excellent publicity. It photographs well and fits inside a quarterly update. Real movement is less tidy. It stops for weather, bodies, new information,

and occasionally a beetle crossing with purpose.

A changed plan is not always a failed plan. Sometimes it is the first evidence that the plan has finally met the world.

When lost, shrink the question. Not where should my life go, but what is the next visible landmark? A door. A glass of water. One honest sentence. The person who knows where the spare key lives.

Then move without demanding that the step explain the whole journey. Arrival may be crooked. Crooked still counts.



ARCHIVE CUT 22: The map says left. The moss says have a biscuit first.

A CHANGED ROUTE IS STILL A ROUTE.

FIELD PRACTICE: Mark one destination, one next landmark, and one place where you are allowed to stop without explaining yourself.

ADVICE FOR COMPLICATED
MAMMALS

DEAR PATCH

NO OPTIMISATION. SOME
MOSS.

I CHANGED MY MIND

Dear Patch: I agreed to a plan, but now it feels wrong. Am I flaky if I ask to change it?

Patch replies: New information is allowed to enter the room. Say what changed, name what you can still offer, and leave the apology smaller than the truth.

PATCH SAYS: UPDATES ARE NOT BETRAYAL

EVERYONE LOOKS FURTHER AHEAD

Dear Patch: Other people seem to have a route. I have three notes, a snack, and no convincing arrow.

Patch replies: You are comparing your ground to their legend. Choose the next thing you can actually touch. Keep the snack. Arrows are famously overconfident.

PATCH SAYS: LANDMARK BEFORE DESTINY

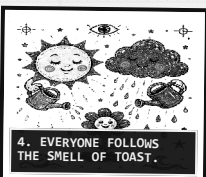
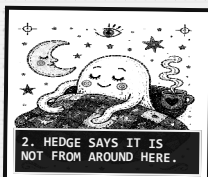
THE WEEKLY MIX

SPORT / COMMERCE / NOTICES / LIES

THE GENTLE DETOUR FUNNIES

THE ARROW ASKS FOR DIRECTIONS

FOUR PANELS / NO LESSON



CLASSIFIEDS

WANTED: Compass that points toward whichever friend has made soup. Brass preferred. Accuracy optional.

FOR SWAP: One impressive shortcut for two ordinary paths with decent lighting.

LOST: My train of thought. Last heard whistling behind the recycling.

FOUND: Small north. Fits in pocket. Keeps leaning toward biscuits.

ROOM TO LET: Quiet bend in the road. Fern view. No straight-line enthusiasts.

SERVICES: I will walk beside you while you decide whether this is the right door.

BAND SEEKS: Triangle player who arrives late but exactly when the triangle is needed.

NOTICE: The public arrow has been granted one afternoon of uncertainty.

BORROW-A-LANDMARK

PORTABLE TREE, DRAMATIC ROCK, OR AUNTIE IN A RED HAT. RETURN BEFORE DUSK.

GOBBO SPORT

Competitive Loitering	2 hours
Purposeful Wandering	1.7 loops
Bench Relay	POSTPONED
Advanced Meandering	STILL ON

MATCH REPORT: Mossboot held a commanding pause by the fountain, then wandered off to inspect a leaf. Judges awarded full points for form.

SHY ARROW REPAIR

WE LISTEN FIRST, THEN GENTLY ROTATE. NO DESTINATION SHAMING. SAME-DAY CHALK AVAILABLE.

CORRECTIONS AND WEATHER

Last week we printed NORTH above a drawing of lunch. The sandwich stands by the decision. Tomorrow: light fog, scattered landmarks, very good pockets after 15:00.

PERSONALS AND EVENTS

SEEKING: Walking companion who enjoys stopping to read tiny signs.

COMMUNITY: Procession for the retired shortcut. Bring chalk.

THURSDAY: Beginner wrong-turn club. Meet wherever we end up.

MISSED CONNECTION: You waved from a bus going elsewhere. Excellent hat.

THREE-DAY FORECAST

MON	Fog, one nearby landmark.
TUE	Sideways sun, useful pockets.
WED	Rain. Routes become suggestions.

WORK AND SYSTEMS

DESK 04 / PLANS MEET
GROUND

WORKPLACE SURVIVAL

A PLAN IS ALLOWED TO MEET REALITY

What to do when the beautiful timeline encounters a door, a body, or Tuesday as it actually exists.

BY PIP KNUCKLEBONE, DEPUTY ROUTE WRANGLER

A plan made on Monday has never met Wednesday. It does not know about the missing cable, the tired person, or the client suddenly remembering a staircase.

When reality arrives, the plan should bend before the people do. This is not weak planning. It is what plans are for.

Name the changed condition, then choose what moves: scope, sequence, time, or help. Refusing to move any of them does not preserve the plan. It merely hides the cost inside somebody.

A useful update says what changed, what it affects, and what choice is now needed. It does not require ceremonial guilt or a heroic little collapse.



TRAINING IMAGE 4B: The timeline bends around an actual mammal and remains a timeline.

ROUTE TRIAGE

Keep: The outcome that still matters.

Move: Sequence, scope, time, or support.

Drop: The part that only proves we suffered.

OFFICE INCIDENT BLOTTER

09:11 / TIMELINE

A milestone moved six days and was later found calm, hydrated, and still meaningful.

11:36 / KITCHEN

The project plan met the kettle. Both agreed the next step was tea before inference.

15:02 / SHARED DOC

A straight arrow was replaced by a dotted curve. Three shoulders descended immediately.

PLAN TAILORING

WE LET OUT TIGHT TIMELINES AND SHORTEN CEREMONIAL STATUS MEETINGS. FITTINGS WHILE YOU WAIT.

DIAGRAM ECOLOGY

THE STRAIGHT ARROW

Common in presentations. Appears decisive but frightens easily when asked where the time comes from.

THE USEFUL LOOP

Returns to earlier knowledge without pretending nothing happened. Thrives near tests and honest notes.

THE DOTTED PATH

Admits uncertainty in public. Natural companion: one named owner and a date that can be renegotiated.

ARTS AND CULTURE

REVIEWS FROM UNDER THE SOFA

EXHIBITION OF THE WEEK

LOCAL CHOIR BECOMES WEATHER

The Drainpipe Nine hold one note until the windows fog and a pigeon quietly removes its hat.

REVIEWED BY MIDGE, WHO HAS HEARD SOUNDS

The first note begins in a bucket and travels outward. By minute three it has entered the floorboards. By minute six, two audience members are remembering rain that never happened.

No melody arrives. This is the point. The note changes because the room

changes around it, collecting coughs, pipes, and one brave radiator tick.

At the end, the choir opens its mouths and leaves the sound standing there alone. Nobody claps until it becomes ordinary air again.



PERFORMANCE VIEW: One note, nine goblins, and a window accepting new responsibilities.

VERDICT

Five hums out of five. Remove one hum if you brought a tune and insist on finding it.

SHORT NOTICES

MAP FOLDED BADLY

Bold creases. Strong pocket work. France briefly touches the legend.

++++.

TWO BOOTS, LIVE

Excellent rhythm on wet pavement. Encore wandered into the shop.

+++.

THE MOON FROM A BUS

Beautiful, intermittent, improved by being lost behind warehouses.

RECIPE: DETOUR SANDWICH

Ingredients: bread, one filling, another filling you found on the way.

Begin confidently. Change direction near the mustard. Cut diagonally, then ignore the diagonal. Eat somewhere not listed in the plan.

OBITUARY: THE SHORTCUT

The shortcut retired Friday after a long career saving four minutes and costing several nice views. It is survived by a lane, a footpath, and the smell of bread.

THIS WEEK'S LISTINGS

MON / UNDERPASS

Echo exchange. Bring one sound, leave with something slightly rounder.

WED / OLD SIGN

Lecture: "Who points the pointers?" Followed by directional biscuits.

SAT / BIG COAT

Pocket cinema presents The Long Way Home, duration seven lindy minutes.

TRAVEL AND SOCIETY

DOWN, AROUND, AND POSSIBLY FORWARD

GRAND EXPEDITION

SUBMARINE ASKS: DOES DOWN COUNT?

The research vessel Wobbly Biscuit descends three metres, finds a spoon, and challenges the tyranny of flat maps.

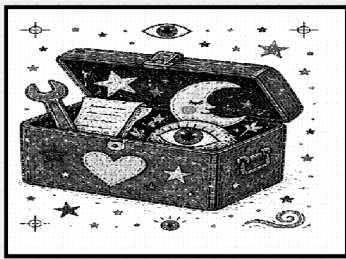
DISPATCH FILED FROM SOMEWHERE BELOW THE DUCK

Captain Brine lowered the submarine after breakfast and immediately objected to every map being viewed from above. "We live in a soup," she reported. "Why is the route always pretending to be a table?"

At two metres the crew passed a bicycle bell, one cloud of silt, and a fish with the

administrative confidence of a harbourmaster.

At three metres they found a spoon. The spoon had no comment, but pointed upward in a way the crew considered needlessly conventional.



SONAR IMAGE: Spoon visible below, though perhaps more philosophically than geographically.

TRAVEL ADVISORY

Pack dry socks, wet courage, and a pencil that can draw arrows vertically. Surface before the kettle misses you.

08:10	08:42	09:05	09:16
Surface. Duck overhead. Morale buttery.	Bell ridge. One ding reported.	Silt district. Visibility becomes an opinion.	Spoon trench. Tea implications unresolved.

PUBLIC NOTICES

ROAD: The lane behind the bakery now curves for emotional reasons.

ASSEMBLY: Residents may gather under the sign and question its tone.

NOISE: Three pings after midnight have been identified as submarine manners.

LIBRARY: Atlases may now be returned with honest annotations.

SOCIETY WHISPER

Spotted at the Compass Ball: Mossboot dancing due west with a teaspoon of considerable mystery.

The interim pebble mayor arrived by pocket and left before speeches.

Correction: We called the route direct. Witnesses report it had three excellent twirls.

MOSTLY DOWN TOURS

SEE THE BOTTOM OF THE POND. GENUINE BUBBLES. COMPLIMENTARY TOWEL IF RETURNED.

MISSED CONNECTIONS

ROUNDABOUT: You waved on your third lap. I understood.

PLATFORM 2: Both trains left. We shared a pear.

POND: Your bubbles spelled maybe. Mine meant hello.

GAMES AND OMENS

RESULTS NOT LEGALLY
BINDING

HOROSCOPES BY MADAM TURNIP

MOSS

The softer route is still a route. Lucky object: a bent paperclip.

CRUMB

A trail is evidence. Leave enough for the version of you coming home.

SNAIL

Your pace makes landmarks visible. The bench has been waiting politely.

BUCKET

You cannot carry every direction. Empty one before adding north.

PUDDLE

The straight road avoids your best reflection. Tuesday favours boots.

BUTTON

Fasten the coat you are wearing, not every coat in the hallway.

MOTH

Circle the light if you like. Arrival is not the only useful motion.

TURNIP

Down is a direction, not a verdict. Dig only where the soil agrees.

FOG

The next ten steps are enough map. Let the horizon keep its secrets.

FIND THE ROUTE THINGS

Nine words are hiding forwards, backwards, and in mild diagonal confusion.

M	A	P	S	B	E	N	D
A	R	R	O	W	Q	U	P
P	A	T	H	S	O	U	P
L	O	O	P	T	U	R	N
B	E	N	C	H	F	O	G
S	N	A	C	K	R	O	C
T	R	A	I	L	N	W	K
H	O	M	E	S	I	D	E

MAP / BEND / ARROW / PATH / SOUP / LOOP / TURN / BENCH
/ FOG

HOUSEHOLD OMENS

Arrow leans: A destination is losing confidence.

Kettle clicks twice: The route now includes tea.

Shoe contains leaf: You have travelled further than your calendar knows.

Crumb in pocket: Provisions, or evidence of previous wisdom.

Plant leans left: Follow only if you photosynthesise.

Map folds itself: A place is requesting privacy.

Three spoons: The submarine has returned with findings.

ANSWERS NEXT WEEK, PROBABLY

THE PUZZLE DESK TOOK A WRONG TURN AND FOUND A MUCH BETTER PENCIL.

PUZZLE POSTBAG

COMPLAINT: The maze exit led to soup. I withdraw the complaint.

CORRECTION: Four down was TURN, not TUNA.

CHALLENGE: Draw north. Make it shy.

YOU ARE ALLOWED TO ARRIVE SIDeways

A crooked arrival is still an arrival. A changed route does not erase the creature who kept moving through it.



ROUTE STUDY 8A: The subject took three bends, one pause, and exactly enough time.

Some arrivals look nothing like the picture made at departure. The bag is muddier. The route has loops. You know more, and some of that knowledge changed the destination.

This does not make the journey false. It makes it responsive.

If you cannot see the grand route, use the small one. Find the next kind landmark. Ask the arrow what it actually knows. Stop where the bench is good.

The weekly forecast calls for scattered certainty with long clear spells of useful wandering.

SUBSCRIBE BY LEAVING A CRUMB

NEW ISSUE EVERY SUNDAY-ISH. DELIVERY TO TABLET, COAT POCKET, OR SUSPICIOUSLY CLEAN ROCK.

FINAL CORRECTION

On page one we called the arrow shy. The arrow says it was exercising healthy directional boundaries.

PRINTED IN BLACK, WHITE, AND THE GREY BETWEEN HERE AND THERE. EDITED BESIDE A FAINT SPECTRAL COFFEE RING. NO GOBLINS WERE STRAIGHTENED IN THE MAKING OF THIS ISSUE.